

Ladan Johari

Design Engineer / Experience Prototyper

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Design engineer focused on AI agent interfaces, developer tools, and interaction systems. I take ambiguous product problems from concept to working code: SwiftUI apps and open-source packages, coded prototypes, and implementation-ready design systems, with an emphasis on state, feedback, and human-in-the-loop control.

SELECTED WORK

Session Indicator — AI Agent Interface, macOS 2026 · [Case Study](#)

SwiftUI · Interaction Design · State-Machine Design · Motion Design · Working macOS App

Designed and built a macOS menu-bar app that restores awareness when multiple AI agents run in parallel, without breaking focus. Defined a five-state session model where motion signals state and color signals exception, with full Reduce Motion accessibility and Apple HIG conventions throughout. Engineered the SwiftUI app end to end: live detection of running agent sessions, state read from session transcripts, all five states shipped and in daily use on my own machine.

Prompted Find — Semantic Video Navigation 2025 · [Case Study](#)

Interaction Design · Semantic Decomposition · Coded Prototype (HTML/JS) · Design Systems

Designed a new interaction pattern for long-form video: ask a question in natural language, get a timestamp you can trust. Built the working prototype on a 74-minute lecture, decomposing the timeline into labeled semantic segments, and architected the understanding layer so real embeddings drop in without changing the interaction.

Xcode Symbol Browser — Developer Tooling, macOS 2024 · [Case Study](#)

SwiftUI · Open Source · Information Architecture · Apple HIG

Redesigned how developers read a codebase's structure, replacing the file tree with a Miller-column spatial view. Engineered the column system as open-source SwiftUI packages (MillerKit, MillerJSON) with unit tests and CI, and cut navigation to a symbol by roughly 30% (click-path comparison).

Trails — Knowledge Navigation, Safari 2024 · [Case Study](#)

Interaction Design · Graph Interface · Information Architecture · Figma

Designed a spatial browsing interface where research becomes a navigable map: pages appear as nodes, navigation leaves a trail, related content clusters automatically. Validated the full interaction model through user testing.

EXPERIENCE

Design Engineer — Independent Practice, Cupertino, CA 2024 – Present

- Design and build interactive interfaces end to end: interaction models, design systems, working prototypes, and open-source SwiftUI packages (see Selected Work).
- Refine every project through ongoing collaboration and structured critique with senior designers and engineers in industry.
- Validate design decisions through hands-on user testing before engineering investment.

Graduate Teaching Assistant — Department of Design, University of California, Davis Sep 2022 – Jun 2025

- Taught human-centered design, digital modeling, and fabrication to 100+ students across six quarters; led studio critiques grounded in systems thinking.
- Two-year TA for Narrative Environments, supporting students who designed the City of Davis annual bike scavenger hunt: nine public activity stations engaging rider teams from across the region.

Workshop Facilitator — SEGD Experiential Design Workshop, Gensler, Washington, D.C. 2024

- Moderated multidisciplinary design teams through ideation, rapid prototyping, and presentation in a conference workshop hosted across two Gensler offices.

Studio Manager — Parviz Tanavoli Atelier, Tehran 2017 – 2021

- Managed the studio of one of Iran's most celebrated sculptors: production and finishing of large-scale bronze and ceramic works, logistics, and materials sourcing.

Architectural & Interior Designer — Tehran 2014 – 2017

- Led interior design for commercial and retail spaces; designed modular furniture systems, an early foundation in component-based design.

SKILLS

AI-Native Workflow	Claude Code · Agentic Development · AI Agent UX · Prompt-Driven Prototyping
Design & Interaction	Interaction Design · Design Systems · Motion Design · Information Architecture · State-Machine Design · Figma · Apple HIG · Accessibility (WCAG, Reduce Motion)
Engineering	SwiftUI · Swift · HTML/CSS · JavaScript · React · Git · GitHub Actions (CI) · Motion-Capture Pipeline (Puppeteer, ffmpeg)

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

MFA Design — University of California, Davis 2024

M.Arch & B.Arch — Azad University School of Architecture, Tehran

First Place, TADAGRANT — TADAEX Digital Art Exhibition, Tehran

SEGD Member — Society for Experiential Graphic Design